Practical 1

HEALTH ASSESSMENT

Learning Objectives

- On completion of this chapter the learner will be able to
- List out the purpose the health assessment
- Describe the technique followed during physical assessment

Introduction

Health is a state of well being. Assesment is based on signs and symptoms observed, examined. It helps in concluding the condition of the individual based on the findings.

Definition

Health assessment is the evaluation of the health status by performing a physical exam after taking a health history.

Objectives

- To collect data pertinent to patient's health status (Subjective and Objective)
- To identify deviations from normal
- To discover the patients strengths, limitations, and coping resources.
- To pinpoint actual problems
- To spot the factors that place the patient at risk of health problems
- To build rapport with the patient and family.

Client Interview

Oldcart

- Onset of health concern or complaint
- Location of pain or other symptoms related to the area of the body involved
- Duration of health concern or complaint
- Characteristics
- Aggravating factors or what makes the concern or complaint worse
- Relieving factors or what makes the concern or complaint better
- Treatments or what treatments were tried in the past or ongoing

Patient history and interview: should be based on.

- present complaint and nature of symptoms
- onset of symptoms
- severity of symptoms
- classifying symptoms as acute or chronic
- health history
- family history
- social history
- current medical surgical and/or nursing
- management
- understanding about medical and nursing plans
- perception of illness

Physical examination

- A complete physical examination includes: Head to toe assessment

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